

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Immeasurable Praise of Qualities"

Āryaaparimitaguṇānuśaṃsanāmadhārāṇī · Toh 851 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཡན་ཏན་བསྐྱུས་པ་དཔག་ཏུ་མྱེད་པ་ཞེས་བརྟེན་གྱི་ཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Immeasurable Praise of Qualities" (Sanskrit Ārya Aparimitaguṇānuśaṃsa-nāma-dhāraṇī, Tibetan Phakpa Yönten Sangpa Pakté Mepa Zhé Jawé Zung) is a short dhāraṇī text devoted to the buddha Amitābha, the Buddha of Immeasurable Light. After an homage to the Three Jewels, it gives a mantra invoking Amitābha's boundless qualities, then sets out the method of reciting it and the benefits said to follow. These include the purification of obscurations accumulated over countless eons, the cleansing of misdeeds and of the four root transgressions through repeated recitation, and the gathering of roots of virtue. The text is Toh 851 in the Kangyur, the Tibetan collection of the Buddha's word, where it belongs to the dhāraṇī class of texts, which preserve protective and purifying formulas together with instructions for their practice.

In the language of India: Ārya Aparimitaguṇānuśaṃsa-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Immeasurable Praise of Qualities."

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namō bhagavate amitābhāya tathāgatāya arhate
samyaksambuddhāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ amite, amitodbhave, amitasambhave,
amitavikrānte, amitagamini, gaganakīrtikare, sarvakleśakṣayamkari svāhā.

The method of this dhāraṇī is as follows. By reciting it once, the obscurations of karma accumulated over a hundred thousand eons are purified. If one recites it three times each day, at the three times of day, all misdeeds are purified. One obtains the roots of virtue that are produced by a thousand buddhas. By reciting it twenty-one times, the four root transgressions are purified. By reciting it one hundred thousand times, one will see the noble Maitreya. By reciting it two hundred thousand times, one will see the noble Avalokiteśvara, the Lord. By reciting it three hundred thousand times, one will see the Tathāgata Amitābha.

Although there are other immeasurable benefits as well, they have been taught here in brief.

Here ends the Noble Dhāranī Called "The Immeasurable Praise of Qualities."

Translator's Notes

- The Tibetan title reads "dpag tu med pa" for the Sanskrit aparimita, giving "Immeasurable Praise of Qualities." The Sanskrit title in the colophon is slightly corrupt (anuśāṃsa for anuśaṃsa), and I have given the normalized form. The mantra is given in a normalized Sanskrit reconstruction from the Tibetan transcription. "A hundred thousand eons" renders bskal pa 'bum, and "a thousand buddhas" renders sangs rgyas stong, taken as the source of the roots of virtue. The "four root transgressions" (rtsa ba'i ltung ba bzhi po) is rendered literally; the text does not specify which set of four is meant, and tradition varies between the four pārājikas of the monastic code and the root downfalls of other vow systems.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.